

Assassin's Creed: Brotherhood

Assassin's Creed Brotherhood, as many suspected, is something between a full-fledged sequel and an expansion pack. Taking into account the many side-quests and numerous sundry distractions, calling Brotherhood a glorified DLC would be underselling it. On the other hand, Brotherhood falls short of qualifying as a proper sequel because the main storyline moves only by a few inches. Plotlines and side-quests aside, the introduction of multi-player game-modes to the series is all that was needed to seal the deal for many. The developers have risen well to the challenge of designing convincing multiplayer for a series where everything is tightly designed around a single-player experience.

Templar's plot

Brotherhood wraps up the saga of Ezio Auditore which was left unfinished at the end of Assassin's Creed II. Desmond revisits the memories of his ancestor to learn the current location of Apple of Eden which will apparently lead the Assassin's to temples left behind by the mysterious Ancients. At the end of Assassin's Creed II, Ezio escapes Rome and returns to the Assassin stronghold in Monteriggioni with his uncle Mario and the Apple of Eden. Events take a full circle as Monteriggioni is attacked by Cesare Borgia who kills Mario and takes the Apple back to Rome. Ezio wakes up injured and battered in Rome which is firmly in the grip of the templar through Cesare Borgia. Cesare's father is the Pope, giving him complete control over Roman power structure. Ezio's task is to wrest control of Rome from the templar by rebuilding Assassin's order and mustering support from various factions.



Brotherhood

Ubisoft has taken the opportunity with this stop-gap release to experiment with multiplayer in Assassin's Creed. There are mainly three multiplayer game modes in Assassin's Creed Brotherhood—Alliance, Wanted and Manhunt.

Wanted is a PvP game mode where a player is assigned an assassination target, while at the same time one or more players are assigned the first player as their target. Before the start of the session, players need to select a character they wish to play. The multiplayer maps are relatively small and they are filled with multiple copies of AI controlled characters that are identical in appearance with other players. Wanted mode creates a fair bit of tension as the player can be the hunter and the hunted at the same time. Hunting involves reading the behavior of characters to discern the AI controlled from the real players. The other two game modes are variations based around the same principle as Wanted.

There is a lot of value packed into this year's Assassin's Creed; especially due to multiplayer mode. In addition, the numerous side-quests, collectibles and challenges offer more replay value than any of its predecessors.

Il Mentore

Ezio's mission for most part of the game is to dismantle the Borgia power structure in Rome before exacting revenge and recovering the Apple. To implement this part of the game, Brotherhood has borrowed game-play mechanics from other games like Crackdown, Fable and combat from Arkham Asylum. Ezio wanes Borgia influence by eliminating numerous guard towers scattered throughout the city, which gives access to its surrounding area and commercial establishments within. This works like a mini-game within Brotherhood and also provides Ezio with a steady stream of income to rebuild the entire city. Additionally, Ezio rebuilds the Assassin's order by hiring new recruits, sending them on missions and upgrading their skills. When these recruits are not away on a mission, Ezio can summon them during fights and assassination assignments. The third part of the plan is to gather the support of Roman mercenary's guild, courtesans and the thieves to deprive Cesare of his money and army. **d**